



GOPALGANJ SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY UNIVERSITY

Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management

BBA Program

Gopalganj, Bangladesh

INDUSTRIAL VISIT REPORT

Industrial Visit Report on Sheraton Dhaka Hotel

Course Code: 450

Date of Submission: 29th June, 2025

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Acknowledgement

First and foremost, all praise and thanks to the Almighty Allah for granting the strength and patience to complete this report successfully. This report has been prepared as part of the 4th year, 2nd semester of the BBA program under the Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management, Gopalganj Science and Technology University (GSTU), Gopalganj.

Preparing this report would not have been possible without the guidance and encouragement of several individuals. Sincere gratitude is owed to the respected report in-charge, Mr. Rubaiyat Shabbir, Assistant Professor, for his valuable support and instruction throughout the project.

Special thanks to Sheraton Dhaka for allowing this opportunity to explore their world-class hospitality standards. Their warm welcome and professional hospitality during the visit greatly enriched practical understanding of the industry.

Lastly, heartfelt appreciation is extended to family, friends, and classmates for their constant encouragement and support.

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Executive Summary

This report documents an industrial visit to Sheraton Dhaka, a five-star hotel operated under the Marriott International brand in the Banani area of Dhaka, undertaken as part of the BBA programme in the Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management at Gopalganj Science and Technology University. The visit formed a practical component of Course 450, intended to connect classroom learning in hotel operations with direct observation of a large-scale, internationally branded property.

The visiting group travelled from the university campus and toured Sheraton Dhaka's key operational areas, including the front office, housekeeping, food and beverage outlets, banquet and conference facilities, and the main and banquet kitchens. The group was addressed by the General Manager, CEO, and department heads, who shared insights into service standards, departmental coordination, and career pathways in luxury hospitality.

This report presents the observations from that visit organized by department: front desk operations and guest interaction; housekeeping standards and room categories; the hotel's corporate, banquet, and event infrastructure; food and beverage service across the hotel's dining outlets and buffet operations; table setting standards for different service styles; beverage service; and the structure and workflow of the kitchen department, including a live food-preparation demonstration. The report concludes with a reflection on how the visit connected academic study with real-world hospitality practice.

Objectives of the Visit

The Motive

The motive of the visit to Dhaka Sheraton Hotel was to explore the operational departments of a globally reputed five-star hotel, and to gain insight into luxury hospitality management, professional service standards, and the backend processes of hotel operations. The experience allowed direct observation of how large-scale hospitality functions in real time, helping bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical experience.

General Observations

The visit covered one of Dhaka's finest international hotels as part of the 4th-year industrial tour. The experience was enriching and, at points, genuinely eye-opening. Several departments were observed, including the front office, rooms division, food and beverage outlets, spa and wellness areas, banquet kitchen, and conference facilities. The hospitality shown by department heads and senior executives, including the General Manager and CEO, was notable, and their structured approach to service delivery reflected international standards. Sincere thanks are due to the department for arranging the visit.

Objectives

- To gain practical insight into luxury hotel operations.
- To understand departmental coordination and hotel management functions.
- To observe the guest handling process and back-of-house activities.
- To bridge the gap between theoretical studies and real-world hospitality practices.
- To build industry knowledge that enhances future career opportunities.

1. Introduction to Sheraton Dhaka

Sheraton Dhaka is a premier five-star property under the globally renowned Marriott International brand, located in the heart of Dhaka's Banani commercial area. Known for its world-class service, refined architecture, and luxurious offerings, Sheraton Dhaka is positioned as a symbol of elegance and modern hospitality in Bangladesh. The hotel is designed to meet the needs of both business and leisure travellers, offering a blend of comfort, functionality, and sophistication.

The property offers state-of-the-art rooms and suites, gourmet restaurants including the Yumi Japanese restaurant, a spacious all-day dining venue known as The Garden Kitchen, modern fitness and wellness centres, a roof-top pool, and fully equipped ballroom and seminar spaces. Every department visited during the tour reflected professionalism, innovation, and attention to detail.

The visiting group engaged directly with department heads, the General Manager, the CEO, and operational staff, who provided insight into their day-to-day procedures and overall hospitality philosophy. The visit offered a comprehensive look at what is required to manage a top-tier hotel while maintaining international service standards.

2. Location

Sheraton Dhaka is located at House 11, Road 17, Block C, Banani, Dhaka 1213, Bangladesh — one of the most prestigious and strategically important areas of the capital. Situated in the heart of Banani, a hub for corporate offices, embassies, upscale restaurants, and luxury shopping, the hotel occupies a position that makes it readily accessible to both domestic and international guests.

The hotel's location balances business convenience with leisure access:

- Approximately 10 kilometres from Hazrat Shahjalal International Airport, roughly a 25–30 minute drive depending on traffic.
- Close proximity to major landmarks including Gulshan 1 & 2, Banani Lake, Hatirjheel, and the Baridhara Diplomatic Zone.
- Direct connection to key roads such as Airport Road and Gulshan Avenue, supporting smooth transportation and connectivity.

The surrounding neighbourhood combines modern urban living with local character — high-rise buildings, boutique cafés, multinational corporations, and stylish shops create an environment suited to Sheraton's diverse clientele. This location strengthens Sheraton's brand presence in Bangladesh and positions the hotel as a leading choice for business travellers, luxury tourists, and event organizers alike.

3. Hotel Visit Programme

On the day of the industrial visit, final-year students from the Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management gathered at the university campus early in the morning. The group departed from the university at 5:30 AM aboard the university bus toward Sheraton Dhaka in Banani, with a brief breakfast stop en route at Bhanga.

The group arrived at Sheraton Dhaka late in the morning and was welcomed by the hotel's front office team. The lobby's elegant architecture and polished decor created an immediate impression of luxury and professionalism. After a short welcome session, hotel authorities organized visitors into two teams to ensure a smooth and effective tour.

As a member of Team A, the author had the opportunity to explore several of the hotel's most exclusive facilities. The group, guided by a Sheraton representative, was taken through the Yumi Japanese Restaurant, located beside the poolside and gym area. Yumi stood out for its serene ambiance, authentic Japanese interior design, and attention to culinary detail — the layout, service style, and premium ingredient use offered a glimpse into the standards of international fine dining.



Figure 1. Sake barrel display at the Yumi Restaurant bar

From there, the group proceeded to the state-of-the-art swimming pool and the fully equipped fitness centre, both reflecting Sheraton's commitment to guest wellness and leisure. The pool area was framed by landscaped surroundings offering a peaceful retreat, while the gym was fitted with modern equipment maintained to a high standard.

Team A then visited the ballroom and seminar facilities, gaining an overview of event management at Sheraton. A highlight was the banquet kitchen, which has the capacity to serve up to 1,200 guests during events — the scale of operations, kitchen workflow, food safety measures, and organizational precision were notable.

The group later gathered in a seminar room, where it was formally welcomed by the General Manager, the CEO, and heads of various departments. This interactive session covered insights into luxury hospitality, career experiences, and operational challenges, helping connect academic study to real-world hotel management.



Figure 2. Visiting students with Sheraton Dhaka officials at The Garden Kitchen terrace

The hotel ensured the comfort of visitors throughout, offering refreshments and ample time to explore and ask questions. The programme concluded in the afternoon, with the group leaving Sheraton Dhaka motivated and enriched with practical knowledge applicable to future careers in hospitality.

4. Front Desk Department

The Front Desk Department, also known as the Front Office, functions as the nerve centre of the hotel. At Sheraton Dhaka, this department operates with a high level of efficiency, elegance, and professionalism. As the first and last point of direct guest interaction, the front desk plays a central role in shaping the overall guest experience.

Guests entering Sheraton Dhaka are welcomed into a sleek, modern lobby staffed by professionals trained in multiple languages and international hospitality standards. The front desk area is spacious and tastefully designed, equipped with current property management systems (PMS) and check-in/check-out technology.

4.1 Functions of the Front Desk Department

The Front Office at Sheraton Dhaka is organized into specialized sections to ensure smooth, personalized service delivery:

Section	Function
Reception / Guest Relations	Greets, checks in, and assists guests throughout their stay, combining efficiency with warmth
Reservations	Handles online and offline booking inquiries through Sheraton's global reservation network
Concierge Services	Assists with travel arrangements, city tours, restaurant reservations, and airport transfers
Bell Desk	Manages luggage handling and escorts guests to their rooms
Call Centre / Telephone Operator	Manages internal and external calls, coordinating communication between departments and guests
Executive Lounge Check-in	Provides separate check-in facilities for VIP guests and loyalty members
Currency Exchange & Business Centre	Supports foreign currency exchange, printing, scanning, and other business needs

Table 1. Functions of the front desk department

4.2 Guest Interaction and First Impressions

Every staff member observed at the front desk maintained eye contact, a welcoming manner, and a polished appearance, reflecting Sheraton's hospitality values. Front office associates use property management systems such as Opera to manage bookings, room allocation, and guest profiles, and clear coordination between the front office and housekeeping was visible as rooms were prepared for new arrivals.

Front desk operations run continuously through rotational shifts, maintaining a consistent service level around the clock. Guest preferences and loyalty program status are recorded in advance and used to personalize service on arrival, reflecting the hotel's attention to guest-specific detail.

5. Housekeeping Department

The Housekeeping Department at Sheraton Dhaka is responsible for the comfort, cleanliness, and aesthetic appeal of the hotel's guest rooms and public spaces. As one of the largest operational departments, it works behind the scenes to uphold the property's five-star standards.

Housekeeping at Sheraton extends beyond cleaning to maintaining a sense of luxury, safety, freshness, and attention to detail throughout the property. The team follows strict schedules and procedures aligned with Marriott's global quality benchmarks.

5.1 In-Room Experience

Sheraton Dhaka offers several room categories, each designed to combine comfort with functionality, cleaned and inspected daily.

Category	Key Features
Deluxe Room	King or twin beds; high-thread-count linens and feather pillows; smart TV; ergonomic work desk; marble bathroom with rain shower; daily housekeeping and turndown service; automated curtains and lighting; soundproof windows
Club Room	Access to the Executive Lounge with complimentary breakfast, snacks, and beverages; private check-in/check-out; enhanced amenities; priority housekeeping
Suites	Separate living, sleeping, and dining areas; kitchenette in select suites; butler service on request; premium linens and robes; bathtub and double-vanity bathrooms; supervisor-level housekeeping inspection

Table 2. Room categories and in-room features

5.2 Functions of the Housekeeping Department

- **Room Cleaning & Servicing:** daily cleaning of all rooms, with deep-clean cycles on rotation.
- **Turndown Service:** evening room refresh with lights dimmed, beds prepared, and complimentary water or chocolates.
- **Public Area Maintenance:** cleaning of lobbies, corridors, elevators, banquet halls, restrooms, gym, and pool area.
- **Linen Management:** supplying and laundering room linens, bathrobes, napkins, and tablecloths.
- **Lost & Found:** systematic management and secure storage of guest items found on the premises.
- **Floral & Scent Control:** maintaining fresh flowers and Sheraton's signature fragrance in public areas.

5.3 Housekeeping Equipment

Equipment Type	Items and Uses
Manual Cleaning Equipment	Dustpans and brooms (solid waste collection); mops and buckets (wet mopping); microfiber cloths (glass and mirror surfaces); trolleys (organized linen, toiletries, and supplies)
Electric Cleaning Equipment	Industrial vacuum cleaners (deep carpet cleaning); steam cleaners (bathrooms and soft furnishings); floor polishers and scrubbers (marble-floored areas); UV sanitation tools (hygiene in high-touch areas)

Table 3. Housekeeping equipment

6. Corporate Point — Business & Event Facilities

At Sheraton Dhaka, the concept of a corporate business point expands into a fully integrated ecosystem of business, conferencing, and event-management facilities, tailored to both local and international clientele. The hotel is designed to serve as a premium venue for corporate meetings, diplomatic conferences, social banquets, workshops, and executive retreats.

The tour of Sheraton's business and event infrastructure reflected both luxury and high operational efficiency. Coordination among departments — Sales & Events, Banquet Operations, Kitchen, Housekeeping, and Engineering — allows the hotel to host high-profile events with precision.

6.1 Key Corporate Facilities

Facility	Details
Ballroom	One of the largest luxury ballrooms in Dhaka; accommodates up to 1,200 guests; features LED walls, mood lighting, movable partitions, and an attached banquet kitchen; suited to weddings, product launches, and international conferences
Meeting Rooms & Boardrooms	Multiple fully equipped boardrooms and breakout rooms, each with high-speed Wi-Fi, built-in LED screens and projectors, video conferencing systems, soundproof glass walls, and ergonomic seating
The Garden Kitchen (Event Catering Hub)	Large-scale banquet facility near the ballroom, capable of preparing food for over a thousand guests; offers live cooking stations, plated service setups, and international menu selections
Executive Lounge	Dedicated space for VIP and club-level guests, offering a quiet setting for informal meetings and networking, complimentary refreshments, private concierge, and panoramic city views

Table 4. Key corporate and event facilities



Figure 3. Dessert and pastry display at The Garden Kitchen buffet

6.2 Departmental Coordination

The teamwork and coordination between departments stood out during the visit. The Sales and Events Team works closely with Housekeeping, IT, Food & Beverage, and Security to ensure every detail of a corporate event runs smoothly — from room bookings and menu planning to audio-visual setup and guest management.

Sheraton's global event-management standards under Marriott ensure end-to-end service, from pre-event planning to post-event feedback, handled with close attention to detail. The Corporate Point at Sheraton Dhaka functions as more than a set of meeting rooms — it is a platform where business and hospitality intersect, elevated by consistent service quality, ambiance, and technology.

7. Food and Beverage Service

The Food and Beverage (F&B) Department at Sheraton Dhaka is one of the hotel's most vibrant and diverse departments, offering fine dining, casual meals, and curated culinary experiences across multiple outlets. The department plays a central role in shaping guest satisfaction and contributes significantly to the hotel's revenue.

The visit covered several of the hotel's major F&B outlets, including the Yumi Japanese Restaurant, The Garden Kitchen, the banquet buffet setup, and executive catering spaces. Each outlet maintained a high standard of hygiene, presentation, and service delivery, consistent with Marriott International's global hospitality standards.

7.1 On-Premise Dining

On-premise food and beverage service at Sheraton Dhaka includes dining experiences delivered within the hotel's physical outlets.

Outlet	Description
Yumi — Japanese Restaurant	Located near the poolside; specializes in authentic Japanese cuisine including sushi, sashimi, tempura, and Teppanyaki, with a tranquil ambiance, minimalist décor, and open kitchen counters
The Garden Kitchen	All-day dining restaurant offering buffet and à la carte menus spanning Indian, Bangladeshi, Western, and Mediterranean cuisine; large, well-lit space with live cooking stations and dessert bars
Lobby Lounge & Café	Positioned in the hotel lobby; provides light snacks, tea, coffee, and pastries throughout the day in a calm setting suited to casual meetings
In-Room Dining	24-hour room service coordinated through the F&B call centre, with attention to presentation and temperature on delivery

Table 5. On-premise dining outlets

7.2 Off-Premise / Outdoor Catering

While Sheraton Dhaka primarily specializes in on-site service, its banquet and events team is equipped to provide outdoor catering for high-profile clients, including corporate conferences and seminars at external venues, embassy functions or private diplomatic dinners, and luxury wedding catering hosted off-site. The hotel provides customized menus, professional chefs, serving staff, cutlery, and mobile kitchen setups depending on client needs, maintaining the same professionalism and hygiene standards as in-house operations.

7.3 Buffet Service

Buffet service is one of the key strengths of Sheraton Dhaka's F&B offering. The lunch buffet observed in The Garden Kitchen included live cooking counters (pasta, grilled meats, stir-fry), salad and appetizer bars, main-course stations featuring a range of international dishes, an extensive dessert selection including pastries, cakes, fruit, and local sweets, and dedicated juice, tea, and coffee stations.

Buffet service placed strong emphasis on hygiene, presentation, and portion control, with staff strategically positioned to assist guests and monitor food replenishment. F&B managers explained the flow design, guest-movement planning, and temperature-control measures used to ensure food safety.



Figure 4. Seating area of The Garden Kitchen

Overall, the food and beverage department at Sheraton Dhaka reflects an international standard of dining, with strong emphasis on cultural diversity, quality, service innovation, and guest satisfaction — every meal observed was structured as a complete experience, from ambiance to guest interaction.

8. Table Setting

Table setting is an essential part of food and beverage service, especially in luxury hospitality, where fine dining is defined as much by presentation and elegance as by the food itself. At Sheraton Dhaka, table setting is treated as a core aspect of service excellence and is carried out with close attention to detail.

The visit covered different table setups across the hotel's restaurants and banquet halls. Each setting followed international standards, adapted to the style of service — à la carte, buffet, banquet, or fine dining. F&B staff demonstrated how table setting is aligned with menu type, guest profile, and cultural context, while maintaining Sheraton's global brand identity.

8.1 Types of Table Settings Observed

Setup	Typical Use	Key Features
Formal Dining Setup	Banquets, executive dinners, diplomatic events	Charger (base) plate; starter and entrée forks (left); dinner knife, fish knife, and soup spoon (right); dessert spoon and fork (top, horizontal); white linen napkin, artistically folded; water goblet, red wine glass, white wine glass; bread plate with butter knife
À la Carte Setup (Yumi and Garden Kitchen)	Everyday restaurant dining	Basic plate setting with one set of fork and knife; soup spoon where applicable; water glass and optional wine glass; napkin folded in creative styles (standing, fan, lotus)
Buffet Setup	Buffet-style service	Plates and cutlery positioned at the start of the buffet line; minimal table setting — fork, knife, and spoon in napkin pockets; water glass and sometimes wine glass; condiments and a centrepiece (flower or candle)

Table 6. Types of table settings observed

8.2 Additional Elements

- **Tablecloths and Overlays:** neutral or pastel colours used to match Sheraton's interior design and lighting scheme.
- **Centrepieces:** fresh flowers, candles, or branded décor used to enhance visual appeal.
- **Cutlery Alignment:** every item placed with precision — equal spacing, alignment with the table edge, and polished to a spotless shine.

The service team's balance of efficiency, aesthetics, and hygiene in table settings was notable throughout the visit, with precision and training evident in every dining space observed.

9. Beverage Service — Cocktails and Mocktails

Beverage service at Sheraton Dhaka is an integral part of its food and beverage experience, ranging from sophisticated cocktails crafted at the hotel bars to refreshing non-alcoholic mocktails served at brunches, lounges, or poolside. Each drink is curated with attention to detail, presentation, and taste. Sheraton follows international mixology standards, and its bartenders are trained in both classic and modern beverage preparation.

During the visit, both the process and presentation of cocktail and mocktail preparation were demonstrated. Sheraton's F&B professionals showed the crafting of several signature drinks while explaining the role of glassware, ingredients, garnishing, and mixing technique.

10. Kitchen Department

The kitchen department at Sheraton Dhaka is the backbone of the hotel's food-production system, supplying its restaurants, banquet halls, in-room dining, and outdoor catering services. The hotel's kitchens are operated by a team of executive chefs, sous chefs, culinary artists, and kitchen stewards, all trained to meet Marriott International's global standards of food safety, hygiene, and service excellence.

The visit included access to both the main kitchen and the banquet kitchen attached to the ballroom. Both were well organized, spacious, and fitted with modern cooking equipment, in a clean, well-ventilated environment clearly marked for workflow efficiency.

10.1 Main Kitchen

The main kitchen is centrally located within Sheraton Dhaka and supports the hotel's core restaurants — including Yumi and The Garden Kitchen — along with room service and the executive lounges. It is organized into specialty sections, each with a defined role and trained staff:

Section	Role
Hot Kitchen	Grilled items, curries, sautéed dishes, and continental cuisine
Cold Kitchen	Salads, dressings, cold appetizers, and cold desserts
Pastry & Bakery	Breads, cakes, muffins, croissants, and dessert items for buffets
Butchery	Raw meat, poultry, and seafood preparation
Vegetable Preparation Area	Cutting, washing, and prepping vegetables
Pantry / Still Room	Beverages, juices, and quick cold orders
Dishwashing Area (Stewarding)	Cleaning and sanitizing utensils and cooking vessels
Chef's Office	Monitoring food orders, shift planning, and coordination with service teams

Table 7. Main kitchen sections

The kitchen brigade system is strictly followed at Sheraton, with a clear role hierarchy: Executive Chef → Sous Chef → Chef de Partie → Commis → Steward. Teams work in shifts to ensure food availability around the clock.

11. Food Preparation — Live Kitchen Demonstration

Food preparation at Sheraton Dhaka follows a structured, hygienic process designed to ensure consistency, flavour, and presentation across all outlets. Guided by trained executive chefs, meal preparation — from breakfast buffets to banquet dinners — is carried out with precision and creativity.

The visit included observation of the live preparation of popular dishes such as fried rice and egg variations, along with items from the banquet kitchen. The chefs explained how mise en place (preparation before cooking), hygiene control, and teamwork are central to large-scale food production.

11.1 Ingredients in Fried Rice (as Demonstrated)

Sheraton's version of fried rice uses fresh, high-quality ingredients with a focus on flavour balance and visual appeal. Key ingredients included:

- White long-grain rice (cooked, cold or one day old)
- Eggs
- Boneless chicken or shrimp (optional)
- Small white onion, finely chopped
- Mixed vegetables (peas, carrots, bell pepper, corn)
- Garlic and ginger paste
- Soy sauce
- Sesame oil
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Spring onions, for garnish

11.2 Preparation Method (Based on the Live Demonstration)

Step	Description
1. Heat the pan	A wok or flat skillet is heated with a dash of sesame oil
2. Sauté aromatics	Garlic, onion, and ginger paste are added and lightly sautéed until fragrant
3. Cook the vegetables	Mixed vegetables are added and stir-fried until slightly tender
4. Push vegetables aside, add egg	Beaten eggs are poured in and scrambled separately before mixing with the vegetables
5. Add cooked rice	Cold, pre-cooked rice is added and stirred continuously to mix evenly
6. Season	Soy sauce, salt, and pepper are added to taste
7. Finish	Spring onions are sprinkled on top before serving for freshness and colour

Table 8. Fried rice preparation sequence

11.3 Chef's Tips for Making Fried Rice

- Use cold or day-old rice to avoid a mushy texture.

- **Cook vegetables and eggs separately** before mixing, for better texture control.
- **Use high heat and a wide pan or wok** to achieve even cooking.
- **Add soy sauce gradually** to avoid overpowering the dish.
- **Avoid overcrowding the pan;** batch cooking helps maintain quality.
- **Finish with fresh garnishing** such as spring onions or sesame seeds for aroma and visual appeal.

This hands-on session illustrated that culinary consistency in a large operation like Sheraton Dhaka — where hundreds of guests are served daily — depends heavily on timing, preparation, and technique. The chefs also discussed how the menu changes seasonally and how international guest preferences are taken into account; dishes such as scrambled eggs, poached eggs, and continental breakfast items are prepared to order to ensure freshness and guest satisfaction.

12. Key Learning Outcomes

The visit to Sheraton Dhaka offered practical exposure to several dimensions of hotel operations that are difficult to grasp through classroom study alone:

- **Departmental interdependence:** front office, housekeeping, F&B, and kitchen operations function as a tightly coordinated system rather than isolated units, with service failures in one department visibly affecting guest experience in another.
- **Standardization at scale:** brand-level systems such as Opera PMS and the kitchen brigade hierarchy allow a five-star, internationally branded hotel to deliver consistent service across hundreds of guest touchpoints daily.
- **Service as a designed experience:** table setting, buffet flow, and guest-movement planning showed that hospitality quality is deliberately engineered, not incidental.
- **Leadership accessibility:** direct interaction with the General Manager, CEO, and department heads demonstrated a leadership culture that remains close to daily operations rather than distant from them.
- **Career relevance:** the range of departments observed — from front office to culinary operations — clarified the breadth of specialization available within the hospitality industry.

13. Conclusion

The industrial visit to Sheraton Dhaka was an enlightening experience that significantly enriched practical understanding of the hospitality industry. As a globally recognized five-star hotel under the Marriott International brand, Sheraton Dhaka provided comprehensive exposure to luxury hospitality operations, modern service delivery, and international hotel management standards.

From arrival, the visiting group was received with genuine warmth and professionalism. The visit functioned as an interactive learning experience rather than a simple tour of the premises, covering departments including the front desk, housekeeping, kitchen, banquet hall, executive lounges, fitness and wellness zones, and restaurants such as Yumi and The Garden Kitchen.

Each area visited reflected the precision, coordination, and guest-centric focus that define Sheraton's brand. The visit showed how departments work together to deliver service — from room preparation to event catering, and from food plating to beverage presentation. Meeting the General Manager, CEO, and departmental heads provided insight into real-time decision-making, team leadership, and strategic hotel operations.

The level of detail, hygiene, technology, and training evident throughout the hotel was particularly notable — from the layout of the main kitchen to the elegance of the table settings and the attentiveness of the front office staff, every element reflected Sheraton's commitment to service excellence.

This visit broadened perspective on how theory is translated into practice within the hospitality field, and reinforced motivation to pursue a career in this dynamic industry. Sincere gratitude is extended to the university, the faculty, and the Sheraton Dhaka team for making this educational experience possible.